INTERNATIONAL EXPERIENCE

CH Zurich (2020–present) · GB London (2015–2020) · FR Paris (2013–2014)



Thomas Zijlstra, CFA

AI Commercialization & Enterprise AI Builder

Zurich, Switzerland · +41 797685745 · zijlstra.thomas@gmail.com · GitHub · Portfolio

Work permit: EU · Switzerland ·

English (Fluent) · German (Fluent) · Dutch (Fluent)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

AI commercialization and financial-services professional with 10+ years of international experience across London, Zurich, and Paris. Investment banking background until 2020: Debt Capital Markets at Société Générale (London) covering DACH and Benelux FIG clients, and investment and finance at a single family office (London). Since 2020 at Accenture (Zurich), leading enterprise AI and digital transformation programmes across regulated financial-services clients. Combines capital-markets origination experience, regulated-industry delivery, and hands-on AI implementation across agentic workflows, enterprise integrations, AI economics, and human-control design.

EXPERIENCE

> Accenture, CH Zurich

Jun 2020 – Present

Financial Services AI & Digital Transformation

- Switzerland NFR Capabilities Team Lead: built and led the local practice, connecting CEE region capabilities and defining go-to-market for non-financial risk.
- NFR practice leadership and go-to-market contribution for the DACH region within the CFO&EV division.
- Originated and led the largest Swiss insurer deal of the year — FINMA regulatory reporting and data adequacy programme.
- Stream Lead for an OeNB central-bank audit at a European core banking provider.
- LIBOR and interest-rate-transition delivery at a European GSIB, applying capital-markets knowledge across derivatives, valuation, and trading-desk structures.
- Developed and implemented AI-agent workflows for RCSA and third-party risk management; built the AI Maturity Assessment for the NFR practice.
- Coordination across business, risk, data, technology, governance, and senior stakeholders.

• Single Family Office, GB London

Aug 2018 – Mar 2020

Investment & Finance Manager

- Company valuation and cash-flow modelling.
- Direct-investment and financing analysis.
- Debt, asset-backed, and equity-financing discussions.
- Engagement with investors, portfolio companies, and financing counterparties.
- Work in an entrepreneurial, growth-stage environment.

■ Société Générale, GB London

Jun 2015 – Jul 2018

Debt Capital Markets Analyst, FIG — DACH and Benelux (selected UK/Ireland)

- DCM origination, structuring, and execution.
- Senior, Tier 2, covered, RMBS, subordinated, and green-bond products.
- Capital-markets reporting, credit work, liquidity analysis, capacity analysis.
- Coordination with M&A, ECM, Legal, Syndication.
- Derivatives, structured products, IRS, FX options, structured notes.

- **Catalina, FR Paris** Jun 2013 – Jan 2014

Data Scientist (Traineeship)

— Consumer and purchasing-behaviour analysis.

— Statistical analysis of transaction data.

— Price-elasticity and product-portfolio analysis.

— Translation of analytical findings into client recommendations.

SELECTED PUBLIC PROJECTS

Enterprise NFR Agent Platform

Public technical demonstrator · https://github.com/tzijlstra-acn/RealAIInfrastrucure

— An enterprise-oriented platform combining multiple specialized agent workflows, a knowledge graph, document intelligence, regulatory analysis, human approvals, enterprise integration patterns, and an MCP layer.

— Commercial relevance: Shows how isolated AI use cases can become a reusable platform and expansion path rather than a collection of disconnected pilots.

— Note: Synthetic demonstration · no client data · not a production deployment

DORA Article 12 AI Control Line

Real client AI implementation · https://github.com/tzijlstra-acn/ProReinsuranceAIWorkflow

— A fully integrated AI workflow built as a client deliverable: connects a live regulatory requirement to AI-generated control updates, infrastructure proposals, policy-engine verification, compliance documentation, human approval gates, and a complete evidence chain.

— Commercial relevance: Demonstrates developed and implemented enterprise AI: real model integration, real state management, real approval workflows, and a traceable evidence chain from regulatory requirement to audit-ready artefact.

— Note: Published with anonymized client context · integration patterns reflect real enterprise architecture

Enterprise AI Economics Simulator

Public executive decision tool · https://github.com/tzijlstra-acn/AICostSimulator

— An interactive cost and scenario tool for estimating the economics of a shared enterprise AI platform, covering industry assumptions, model routing, cloud/sovereign/on-premise scenarios, and cost-vs-gain projections.

— Commercial relevance: Demonstrates the ability to translate technical architecture into buyer-facing economics and proposal content.

— Note: All prices, benchmarks, gains, and allocation values are illustrative planning assumptions.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

CFA Charterholder

CFA Institute

MSc Finance and Investments

2014 – 2015

Rotterdam School of Management, Erasmus University

Cum laude · 8.5/10

Thesis: "Credit rating changes and their effect on asymmetric information"

BSc International Business Administration

2011 – 2014

Rotterdam School of Management

Honours · 8.1/10

CAPABILITIES

Commercial & Strategic

AI commercialization · opportunity qualification · customer discovery · buyer/stakeholder mapping · executive communication · financial modelling · AI economics · proposal development · paid-pilot design · program delivery · commercial hypothesis testing · expansion-playbook design

AI & Architecture

agentic workflows · LangGraph · LangChain · human-in-the-loop · knowledge graphs · document intelligence · model-provider abstraction · evaluation design · AI governance · model-routing and cost models

Engineering & Integration

Python · FastAPI · REST APIs · ServiceNow integration patterns · MCP · NetworkX · SQLite · TypeScript · JavaScript · React · Next.js · HTML/CSS · workflow state machines

Financial Services

Non-Financial Risk · RCSA · TPRM · DORA · AI risk management · regulatory reporting · data adequacy · LIBOR transition · capital markets · FIG · derivatives/valuation concepts

LANGUAGES

English (Fluent) · German (Fluent) · Dutch (Fluent)